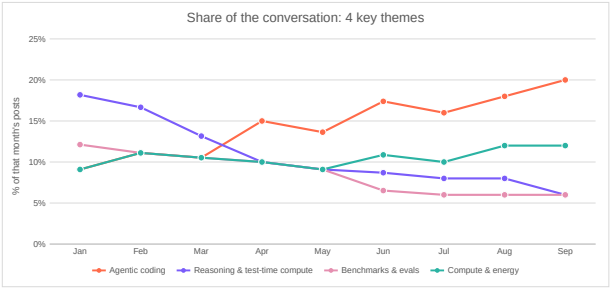
Signal & Noise 2026

How social media talked about LLMs, Jan–Sep 2026 · hand-coded sample of 387 posts · Northbank Media Lab

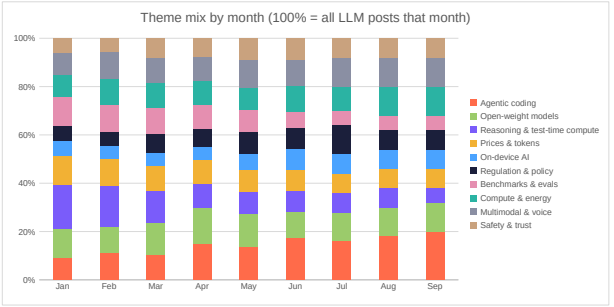
Share of the conversation: each theme's % of that month's LLM posts

Month	Agentic coding	Open-weight models	Reasoning & test-time compute	Prices & tokens	On-device AI	Regulation & policy	Benchmarks & evals	Compute & energy	Multimodal & voice	Safety & trust
Jan	9%	12%	18%	12%	6%	6%	12%	9%	9%	6%
Feb	11%	11%	17%	11%	6%	6%	11%	11%	11%	6%
Mar	11%	13%	13%	11%	5%	8%	11%	11%	11%	8%
Apr	15%	15%	10%	10%	5%	8%	10%	10%	10%	8%
May	14%	14%	9%	9%	7%	9%	9%	9%	11%	9%
Jun	17%	11%	9%	9%	9%	9%	7%	11%	11%	9%
Jul	16%	12%	8%	8%	8%	12%	6%	10%	12%	8%
Aug	18%	12%	8%	8%	8%	8%	6%	12%	12%	8%
Sep	20%	12%	6%	8%	8%	8%	6%	12%	12%	8%
Jan–Sep	15%	12%	10%	9%	7%	8%	8%	11%	11%	8%



Change and tone by theme

Theme	Share of all posts	Share in Jan	Share in Sep	Change	positive	neutral	negative
Agentic coding	15%	9%	20%	+11 pts	48%	41%	10.3%
Open-weight models	12%	12%	12%	0 pts	48%	31%	20.8%
Reasoning & test-time compute	10%	18%	6%	-12 pts	35%	53%	12.5%
Prices & tokens	9%	12%	8%	-4 pts	31%	17%	52.8%
On-device AI	7%	6%	8%	+2 pts	44%	33%	22.2%
Regulation & policy	8%	6%	8%	+2 pts	53%	34%	12.5%
Benchmarks & evals	8%	12%	6%	-6 pts	50%	47%	3.1%
Compute & energy	11%	9%	12%	+3 pts	22%	37%	41.5%
Multimodal & voice	11%	9%	12%	+3 pts	37%	44%	18.6%
Safety & trust	8%	6%	8%	+2 pts	20%	33%	46.7%
All themes	100%	100%	100%		39%	37%	23.3%



Illustrative, synthetic data. The 387 fictional posts are a hand-coded sample of a much larger stream. The Counts sheet shows the raw counts.

Chart data: share of the conversation, 4 key themes

Month	Agentic codin	Reasoning &	Benchmarks &	Compute & energy
Jan	9%	18%	12%	9%
Feb	11%	17%	11%	11%
Mar	11%	13%	11%	11%
Apr	15%	10%	10%	10%
May	14%	9%	9%	9%
Jun	17%	9%	7%	11%
Jul	16%	8%	6%	10%
Aug	18%	8%	6%	12%
Sep	20%	6%	6%	12%

Chart data: % of posts that are negative

Theme	% negative
Benchmarks &	3.1%
Agentic codin	10.3%
Reasoning &	12.5%
Regulation &	12.5%
Multimodal &	18.6%
Open-weight	20.8%
On-device AI	22.2%
Average, all th	23.3%
Compute & en	41.5%
Safety & trust	46.7%
Prices & token	52.8%

